16. This is a sensitive issue-based story which tries to sensitise the readers about

(a) Male chauvinism and infidelity
(b) Love and betrayal
(c) Lack of legal safeguards for women
(d) Influence of patriarchal mindset

Ans. (d) : According to the passage, Manak's mother is yearning to have a grandson to continue the family name, which shows the ill effects of patriarchal attitude.

Passage-13

The ultimate aim of government is not to rule or control by fear, nor to demand obedience, but conversely, to free every man from fear, that he may live in all possible security. In other words, to strengthen his natural right to exist and work without injury to himself or others. The object of government is not to change men from rational beings into beasts or puppets. It should enable them to develop their minds and bodies in security, and to employ their reason unshackled.

17. Which among the following is the *most logical and rational inference* that can be made from the above passage?

(a) The true aim of government is to secure the citizens their social and political freedom.
(b) The primary concern of government is to provide absolute social security to all its citizens.
(c) The best government is the one that allows the citizens to enjoy absolute liberty in all matters of life.
(d) The best government is the one that provides absolute physical security to the people of the country.

Ans. (a) : The passage refers to the major work of the government, so it would not be appropriate to consider the work of the government as the basis or principle of the best government. On this basis option (c) and (d) are proved wrong. The passage talks about social and political freedom. Hence option (a) is correct answer.

Passage-14

Our municipal corporations are understaffed. The issue of skills and competencies of the staff poses an even greater challenge. Urban services delivery and infrastructure are complex to plan and execute. They require a high degree of specialization and professionalism. The current framework within which municipal employees, including senior management, are recruited does not adequately factor in the technical and managerial competencies required. Cadre and recruitment rules only specify the bare minimum in academic qualifications. There is no mention of managerial or technical competencies, or of relevant work experience. This is the case with most municipal corporations. They also suffer from weak organisation design and structure.

18. Which among the following is the *most logical and rational assumption* that can be made from the above passage?

(a) The task of providing urban services is a complex issue which requires the organisational expansion of municipal bodies all over the country.
(b) Our cities can provide better quality of life if our local government bodies have adequate staff with required skills and competencies.
(c) Lack of skilled staff is due to the absence of institutions which offer the requisite skills in city management.
(d) Our country is not taking advantage of the demographic dividend to manage the problems associated with rapid urbanization.

Ans. (b) : In the passage, the author is showing concern about the small number of employees working in municipal corporation and their skill and efficiency. Hence option (b) is the most logical and rational presumption, because the author is demonstrating that excellent and efficient employee practices, can improve the quality of urban life.

Passage-15

Flamingos in large flocks in the wild are social and extremely loyal. They perform group mating dances. Parents are very fond of their chicks, gathering them into creches for protection while both males and females fly off to search for food.

19. Which among the following is the *most logical corollary* to the above passage?

(a) Mass nesting in all species of birds is essential to ensure complete survival of their offspring.
(b) Only birds have the capacity to develop social behaviour and thus can do mass nesting to raise their chicks in safety.
(c) Social behaviour in some species of birds increases the odds of survival in an unsafe world.
(d) All species of birds set up creches for their chicks to teach them social behaviour and loyalty.

Ans. (c) : Flamingos are social & loyal and when the male and female fly away in search of food, their chicks are taken care by other member of the group. So, the most logical regression would be option (c) as it shows the importance of group and social behavior.

Passage-16

Vast numbers of Indian citizens without bank accounts live in rural areas, are financially and functionally illiterate, and have little experience with technology. A research study was conducted in a particular area in which electronic wage payments in Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) are meant to go directly to the poor. It was observed that recipients often assume that the village leader needs to mediate the process, as was the case under the previous paper-based system. Among households under this research study area who claimed to have at least one bank account, over a third reported still receiving MGNREGS wages in cash directly from a village leader.

20. What is the *most logical, rational and crucial message* that is implied in the above passage?

(a) MGNREGS should be extended only to those who have a bank account.
(b) The paper-based system of payments is more efficient than electronic payment in the present scenario.
(c) The goal of electronic wage payments was not to eliminate mediation by village leaders.
(d) It is essential to provide financial literacy to the rural poor.

Ans. (d) : Concern has been expressed in the passage that instead of electronic payment under MNREGA, labourers consider the mediation of the village leader necessary to get wages in this process. This fact emphasizes the increasing spread of financial technology and functionality. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

Passage-17

Individuals, groups and leaders who promote human development operate under strong institutional, structural and political constraints that affect policy options. But experience suggests broad principles for shaping an appropriate agenda for human development. One important finding from several decades of human development experience is that focusing exclusively on economic growth is problematic. While we have good knowledge about how to advance health and education, the causes of growth are much less certain and growth is often elusive. Further, an unbalanced emphasis on growth is often associated with negative environmental consequences and adverse distributional effects. The experience of China, with its impressive growth record, reflects these broader concerns and underlines the importance of balanced approaches that emphasize investments in the non-income aspects of human development.

21. With reference to the above passage, consider the following statements :

1. In developing countries, a strong institutional framework is the only requirement for human development and policy options.
2. Human development and economic growth are not always positively inter-related.
3. Focusing only on human development should be the goal of economic growth.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : To say that the only requirement for human resource development is a strong institutional framework would be a different point. This is in sync with option (3). The example of China has a resemblance to option (2). Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

22. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. Higher economic growth is essential to ensure reduction in economic disparity.
2. Environmental degradation is sometimes a consequence of economic growth.

Which of the above is/are valid assumption/ assumptions?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) : In reality, environmental degradation is a natural result of economic development. Hence, option (b) will be the correct answer. Although the passage is explaining the importance of economic development, but at the same time it also considers it problematic. Therefore, we cannot conclude that opinion to make economic development an important factor in reducing economic inequality.

Directions for the following 8 (eight) items :

Read the following six passages and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage-18

Human history abounds in claims and theories confining the right of governing to a few select citizens. Exclusion of the many is justified on the ground that human beings may be rightfully segregated for the good of society and viability of the political process.

23. Which one of the following statement is *least essential* as a part of the argument in the above passage?

(a) Man seeks control over external things affecting him.
(b) In society, there are `super' and `sub' human beings.
(c) Exceptions to universal citizen participation are conducive to systemic efficacy.
(d) Governing implies recognition of disparities in individual capacities.

Ans. (a) : Minimum requirement means - almost no need. The author thinks that it would be justified to give preference to a few over the rights of many. From this it is clear that options (b), (c) & (d) are related to the above argument but not (a). Hence, the correct answer will be (a).

Passage-19

By 2050, the Earth's population will likely have swelled from seven to nine billion people. To fill all those stomaches—while accounting for shifting consumption patterns, climate change, and a finite amount of arable land and potable water—some experts say food production will have to double. How can we make the numbers add up? Experts say higher yielding crop varieties and more efficient farming methods will be crucial. So will waste reduction. Experts urge cities to reclaim nutrients and water from waste streams and preserve farmland. Poor countries, they say, can improve crop storage and packaging and rich nations could cut back on resource-intensive foods like meat.

24. Which one of the following statements *best sums up* the above passage?

(a) The population of the world is growing very fast.
(b) Food security is a perennial problem only in developing countries.